

“Educational kits covering the whole spectrum of engineering education—especially with PC interfacing, data logging and automation—are in demand by institutes and colleges —Ilesh Shah, proprietor, Abvolt Technologies

manufacturers like Agilent Technologies have directly entered this domain offering a complete lab-solution and acting as a one-stop-shop for the consumers.

Garg cites lack of awareness in tier 2 and tier 3 cities, marketing budget and innovation as the typical challenges. “To overcome these challenges, innovative marketing methods and free technical camps and competitions are some of the strategies that the players are adopting,” he adds.

Dagli strongly feels the need for a paradigm shift from current demotype trainers to hands-on troubleshooting type trainers that are widely used in developed countries.

“The kits should have good educa-

tional value. Educational trainers, in particular, lack the educational value. While purchasing the kits, majority of the educational institutes look at only meeting the curriculum requirements and aren’t bothered about encouraging innovation amongst students,” says B.M. Shah, proprietor, Edkits.

Selling kits online

As lot of traders exist in this market, who simply import and sell. Consumers are confused about what to buy and where to buy. So in this case, online with offline model is going to work where consumers can visit and understand the product better. Also, online is a great channel to reach out to the large nascent market for these kits.

However, the reliability of online providers is questionable. “Some of the online channels are addressing the consumers’ needs very well, but again these channels are as good as what they have to offer. The quality of some of their kits is still a suspect, which is one of the big challenges that the consumers face while buying through these channels,” shares Pathy Iyer.

“Not enough technical information is provided on the webpage where products are posted. Also, payment gateway services are not good in India for low volumes. The range of products offered by online players is also not wide enough,” explains Garg.

“Other challenges include the collaborative purchases. Whereas the online channel serves very well the needs of hobbyists or independent researchers, it is of limited use for government or institutional buyers who have their own purchase processes,” adds Pathy Iyer. ●

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